

Instructions of Prophet Muhammad (SM.) in His Farewell Sermon

During his **last pilgrimage in 632 CE at Mount Arafat**, Prophet Muhammad (SM.) delivered a **historic sermon** that emphasized human rights, justice, and ethical conduct. Below are the **key instructions** from the sermon:

1. Human Equality & Brotherhood

- “No Arab is superior to a non-Arab, and no non-Arab is superior to an Arab; no white person is superior to a black person, and no black person is superior to a white person—**except by piety (taqwa).**”
- “All of you are from Adam, and Adam was created from dust.”

2. Sanctity of Life, Property, and Honor

- “Your blood, your property, and your honor are **sacred** like this day (Hajj), this month (Dhul-Hijjah), and this place (Makkah).”
- “Do not oppress one another.”

3. Prohibition of Oppression & Exploitation

- **No injustice:** “Do not commit oppression, for Allah has forbidden injustice.”
- **No interest (riba):** “All forms of interest (usury) from the pre-Islamic era are abolished.”
- **No revenge:** “All claims of blood vengeance from the time of ignorance are abolished.”

4. Rights of Women

- “Treat women kindly, for they are your partners and helpers.”
- “You have rights over your wives, and they have rights over you.”

5. Rights of Slaves & Servants

- “Feed them with what you eat, and clothe them with what you wear.”
- “Do not burden them with tasks beyond their capacity.”

6. Justice & Accountability

- “You will meet your Lord, and He will ask about your deeds.”
- “Return trusts (Amanah) to their rightful owners.”

7. Abolishment of Pre-Islamic Customs

- “All practices from the **Age of Ignorance (Jahiliyyah)** are **abolished**, except for those upheld by Islam.”

8. Importance of Quran & Sunnah

- “I leave behind **the Quran and my Sunnah**—if you hold fast to them, you will never go astray.”

9. Unity of the Muslim Ummah

- “Do not divide among yourselves; stay united as one brotherhood.”

10. Worship and Obedience to Allah

- “Establish prayer, pay Zakat, fast during Ramadan, and perform Hajj if able.”
- “Obey your leaders as long as they follow the guidance of Allah.”

11. Final Message & Testimony

- “Have I conveyed the message? O Allah, be my witness.”
- “Let those who are present convey this message to those who are absent.”

Significance

- ☐ This sermon serves as a **universal declaration of human rights, justice, and social responsibility**.
- ☐ It **aligns with many modern ethical and human rights principles**, proving its **timeless relevance**.
- ☐ It remains a **moral guide** for Muslims and all of humanity.

This **Farewell Sermon** is considered one of the greatest speeches in history, summarizing **Islamic ethics, law, and justice**.

Declaration of Human Rights

The **Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR)** was adopted by the **United Nations (UN)** on **December 10, 1948** as a response to the atrocities of World War II. It serves as a global standard for fundamental human rights, ensuring **freedom, equality, and dignity** for all people, regardless of nationality, race, or religion.

Key Features of the UDHR:

- ✓ **Universal & Inalienable** – Applies to all human beings.
- ✓ **Indivisible & Interdependent** – Rights are connected and equally important.
- ✓ **Legally Non-Binding** – A moral guideline for nations to follow.

Articles 1-10: Basic Freedoms & Equality

1. **All human beings are born free and equal** in dignity and rights.
2. **Freedom from discrimination** based on race, gender, religion, etc.
3. **Right to life, liberty, and security** of person.
4. **Freedom from slavery** and servitude.
5. **Freedom from torture** and cruel, inhuman treatment.
6. **Right to legal recognition** everywhere.
7. **Equality before the law** and protection against discrimination.
8. **Right to seek justice** through competent courts.
9. **Freedom from arbitrary arrest, detention, or exile.**
10. **Right to a fair and public trial** by an independent tribunal.

Articles 11-20: Legal Protections & Individual Freedoms

11. **Presumption of innocence** until proven guilty.
12. **Right to privacy** in family, home, and correspondence.
13. **Freedom of movement** within and outside one's country.
14. **Right to seek asylum** in other countries.
15. **Right to nationality** and protection from statelessness.
16. **Right to marry and form a family** with equal rights.
17. **Right to own property** individually or collectively.
18. **Freedom of thought, conscience, and religion.**
19. **Freedom of opinion and expression.**
20. **Freedom of peaceful assembly and association.**

Articles 21-30: Political, Economic, Social & Cultural Rights

21. **Right to participate in government** and free elections.
22. **Right to social security** and economic protection.
23. **Right to work, fair wages, and labor protection.**
24. **Right to rest and leisure**, including reasonable work hours.
25. **Right to an adequate standard of living**, including food, shelter, and healthcare.
26. **Right to education**, free at the elementary level.
27. **Right to participate in cultural life and scientific advancements.**
28. **Right to a social and international order** that ensures these rights.
29. **Duties to the community** and respect for the rights of others.
30. **No one can destroy the rights** set forth in this declaration.

The UDHR remains a **guiding framework for human rights worldwide**, influencing **national constitutions, laws, and international treaties**.

Connections Between the Farewell Sermon of Prophet Muhammad (SM.) and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR)

Human Rights: Human Rights in Islam, Sermon of Prophet (SM.) at his last pilgrimage, United Nations – Universal declaration of Human Rights (Articles 1-10) Critical discussion.

The **Farewell Sermon (632 CE)** of **Prophet Muhammad (SM.)** and the **Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR, 1948)** share many principles of **justice, equality, and human dignity**. Below are key **connections between the Prophet's instructions and the UDHR articles**:

1. Human Equality & Non-Discrimination

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- “No Arab is superior to a non-Arab, and no non-Arab is superior to an Arab; no white person is superior to a black person, and no black person is superior to a white person—except by piety (taqwa).”

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 1:** "All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights."
- **Article 2:** "Everyone is entitled to all the rights and freedoms... without distinction of race, color, sex, language, or religion."

✓ **Both emphasize racial and social equality and prohibit discrimination.**

2. Sanctity of Life, Property, and Honor

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- “Your blood, your property, and your honor are sacred like this day (Hajj), this month (Dhul-Hijjah), and this place (Makkah).”

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 3:** "Everyone has the right to life, liberty, and security of person."
- **Article 12:** "No one shall be subjected to arbitrary interference with his privacy, family, home, or honor."

✓ **Both protect the right to life, property, and personal security.**

3. Justice & Accountability

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- “Do not commit oppression, for Allah has forbidden injustice.”
- “You will meet your Lord, and He will ask about your deeds.”

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 7:** "All are equal before the law and are entitled without discrimination to equal protection of the law."
- **Article 10:** "Everyone is entitled in full equality to a fair and public hearing by an independent and impartial tribunal."

✓ **Both emphasize justice, fairness, and legal equality.**

4. Prohibition of Oppression & Exploitation

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- “All forms of interest (riba) from the pre-Islamic era are abolished.”
- “All claims of blood vengeance from the time of ignorance are abolished.”

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 4:** "No one shall be held in slavery or servitude; slavery and the slave trade shall be prohibited in all their forms."
- **Article 8:** "Everyone has the right to an effective remedy... for acts violating the fundamental rights granted to him."

✓ **Both oppose economic and social exploitation.**

5. Women's Rights

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- “Treat women kindly, for they are your partners and helpers.”
- “You have rights over your wives, and they have rights over you.”

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 16:** "Men and women of full age... have the right to marry and to found a family. They are entitled to equal rights as to marriage, during marriage, and at its dissolution."

✓ **Both emphasize women's dignity, rights, and fair treatment in marriage.**

6. Rights of Servants & Workers

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- "Feed them with what you eat, and clothe them with what you wear."
- "Do not burden them with tasks beyond their capacity."

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 23:** "Everyone has the right to work, to free choice of employment, to just and favorable conditions of work."

✓ **Both emphasize fair labor practices and workers' rights.**

7. Freedom of Religion & Worship

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- "I am leaving you with the Quran and my Sunnah; if you follow them, you will never go astray."

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 18:** "Everyone has the right to freedom of thought, conscience, and religion."

✓ **Both emphasize the right to follow and practice one's religion.**

8. Unity & Brotherhood

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- "Do not divide among yourselves; stay united as one brotherhood."

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 20:** "Everyone has the right to freedom of peaceful assembly and association."

✓ **Both encourage social unity and cooperation.**

9. Importance of Leadership & Governance

☐ **Farewell Sermon:**

- "Obey your leaders as long as they follow the guidance of Allah."

☐ **UDHR Connection:**

- **Article 21:** "Everyone has the right to take part in the government of his country, directly or through freely chosen representatives."

✓ **Both stress responsible leadership and governance.**

Conclusion: Strong Parallels Between the Two

☐ **The Farewell Sermon and the UDHR share key principles of human rights, justice, equality, and dignity.**

☐ **Many of the UDHR's articles align with Islamic teachings, proving Islam's early emphasis on human rights.**

☐ **The Farewell Sermon serves as an Islamic declaration of human rights that complements modern frameworks like the UDHR.**

☐ **Thus, Prophet Muhammad (SM.)'s sermon remains timeless, guiding both Muslims and the world toward justice, peace, and equality.**